Help Desk Lab Report

Active Directory User Account Management – Personnel Changes

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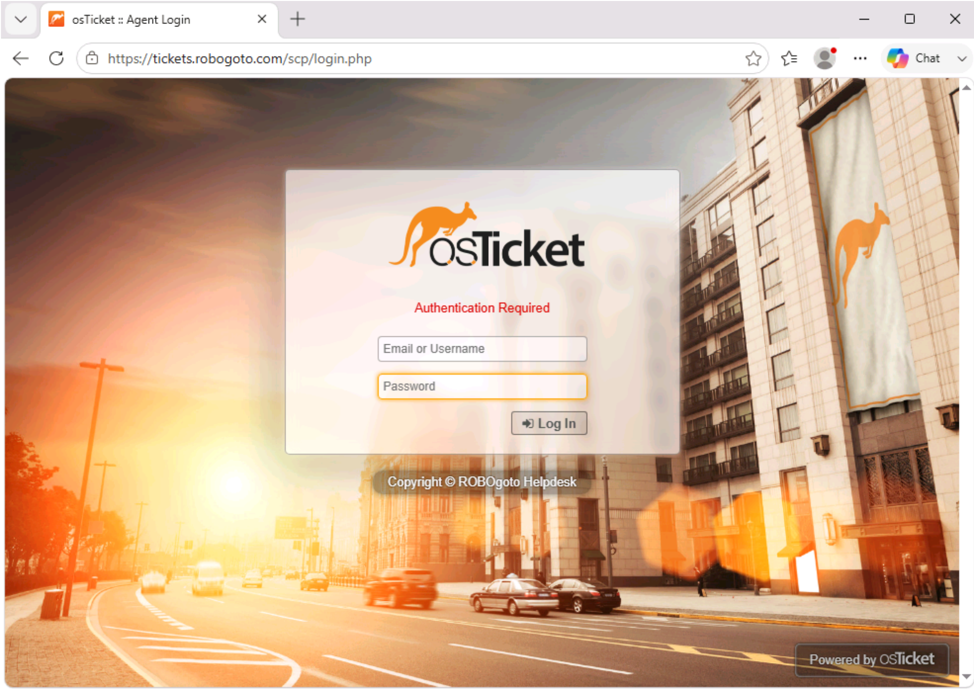
Date: July 24, 2026
Lab Type: CompTIA A+ Practical Exercise (VM)
Environment: Windows Server Active Directory

Objective

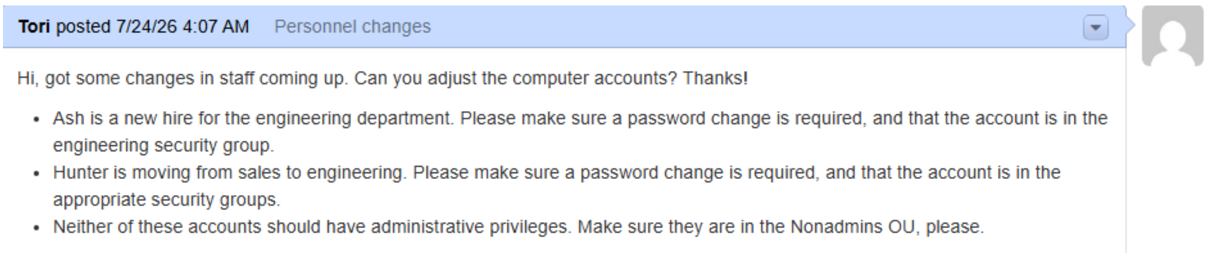
The purpose of this lab was to practice common Help Desk tasks related to Active Directory user management. The exercise involved creating a new user account, updating an existing user's department, assigning security groups, enforcing password policies, and ensuring both users followed the organization's security standards.

Scenario

The first procedure performed was authentication into the osTicket platform, allowing access to the helpdesk management system.



Tori from the Human Resources department submitted a Ticket regarding upcoming personnel changes.


Tori posted 7/24/26 4:07 AM Personnel changes

Hi, got some changes in staff coming up. Can you adjust the computer accounts? Thanks!

- Ash is a new hire for the engineering department. Please make sure a password change is required, and that the account is in the engineering security group.
- Hunter is moving from sales to engineering. Please make sure a password change is required, and that the account is in the appropriate security groups.
- Neither of these accounts should have administrative privileges. Make sure they are in the Nonadmins OU, please.

Ash

- Create a new account for **Ash** in the Engineering department.
- Require a password change at the next logon.
- Add Ash to the **Engineering Security Group**.

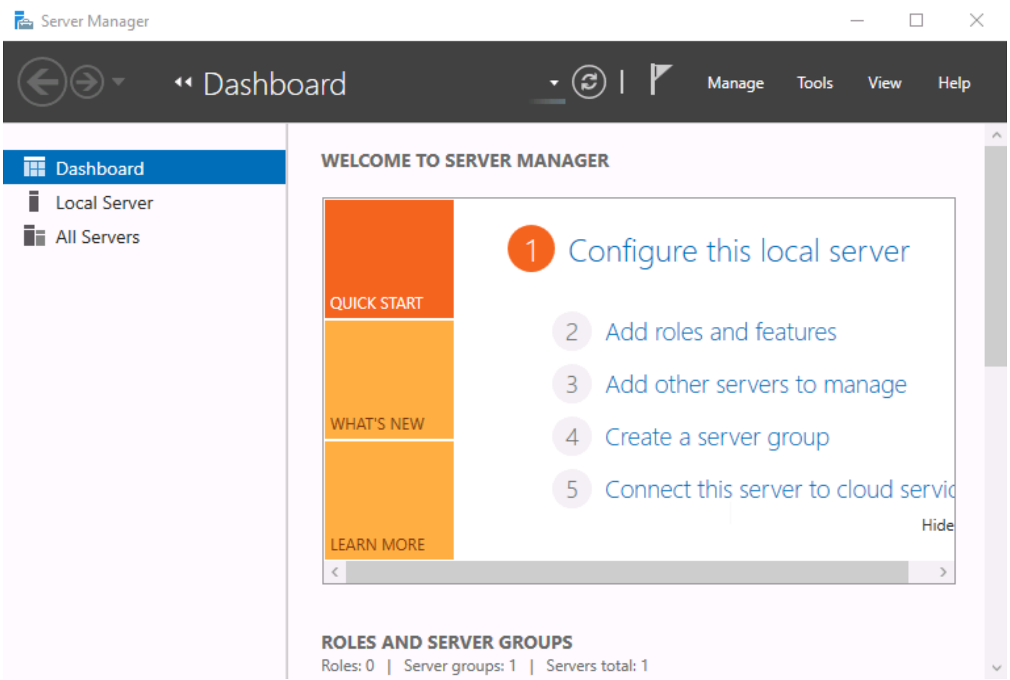
Hunter

- Transfer **Hunter** from Sales to Engineering.
- Require Hunter to change their password at the next logon.
- Move Hunter to the appropriate **Engineering Security Group**.
- Ensure neither account has administrative privileges.
- Place both accounts in the **NonAdmins** Organizational Unit (OU).

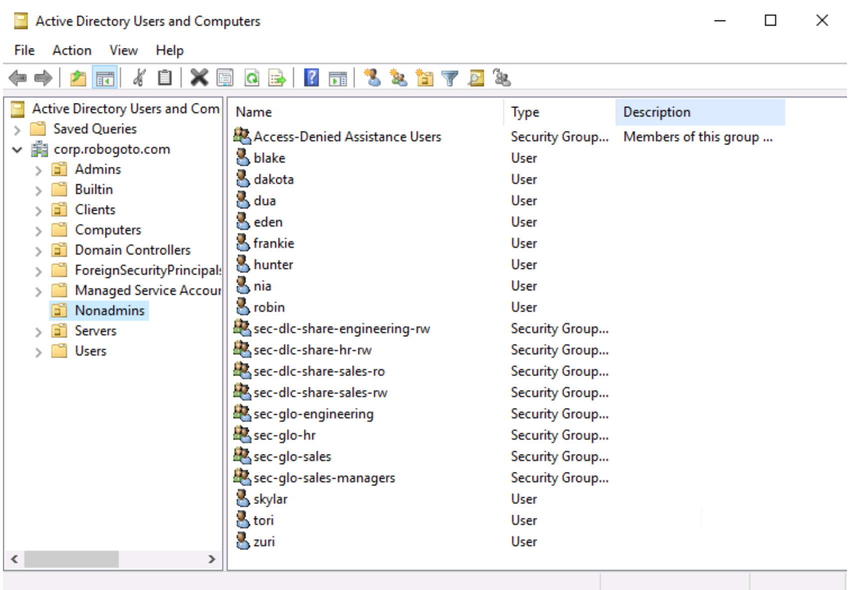
Tasks Performed

1. Creation of the "Ash" User Account and Assignment to the Engineering Department

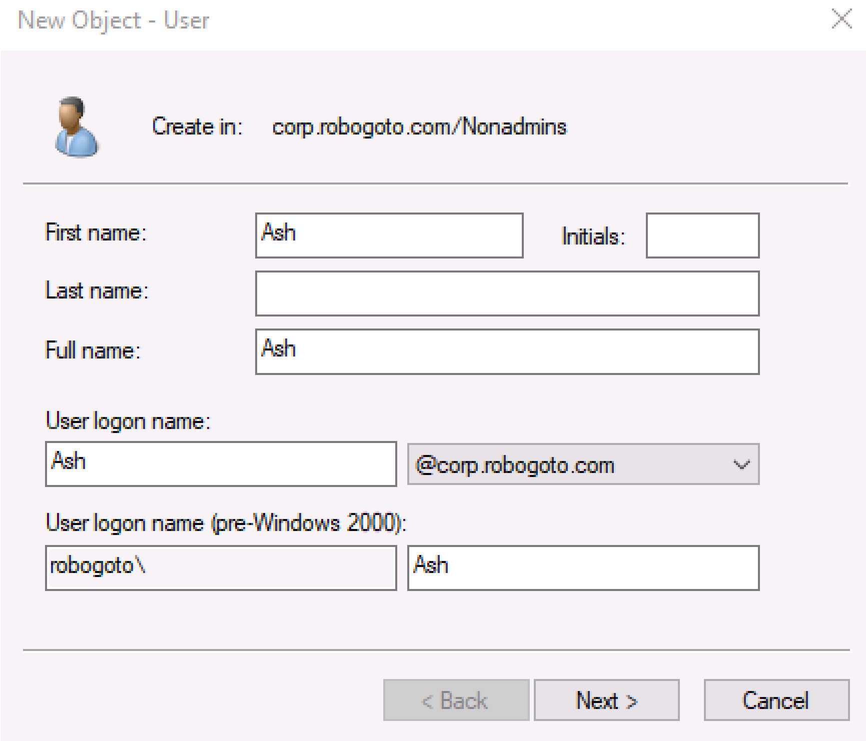
After reviewing the assigned tasks and understanding the required procedures, the next step was to access **Server Manager**, a Windows administration tool used to manage users, roles, services, and other server-related configurations.



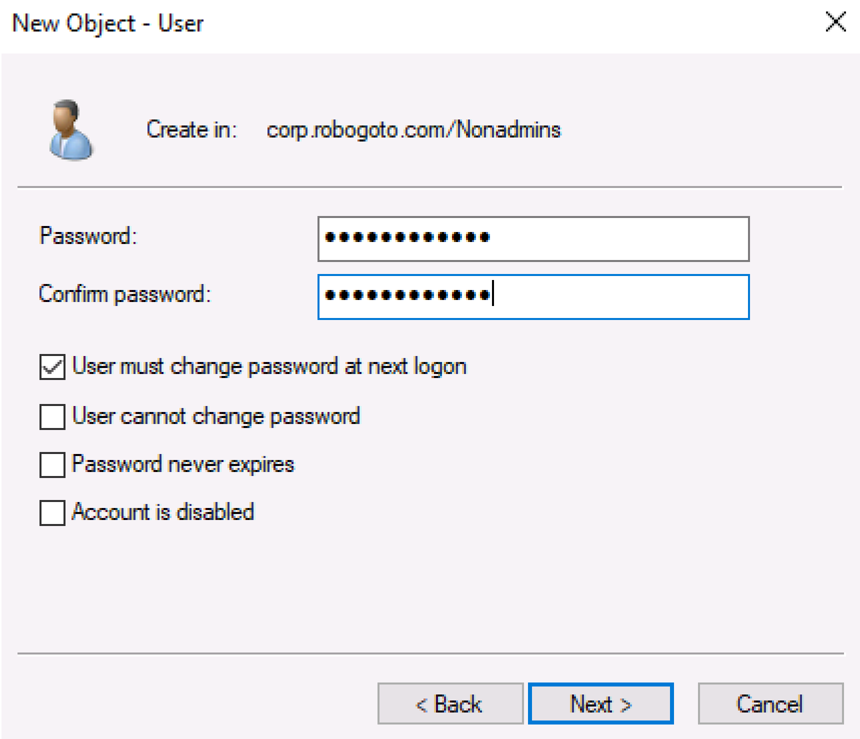
Within **Server Manager**, I navigated to **Tools → Active Directory Users and Computers** to access the Active Directory management console, which allows administrators to create, modify, and manage user accounts, groups, and organizational settings.



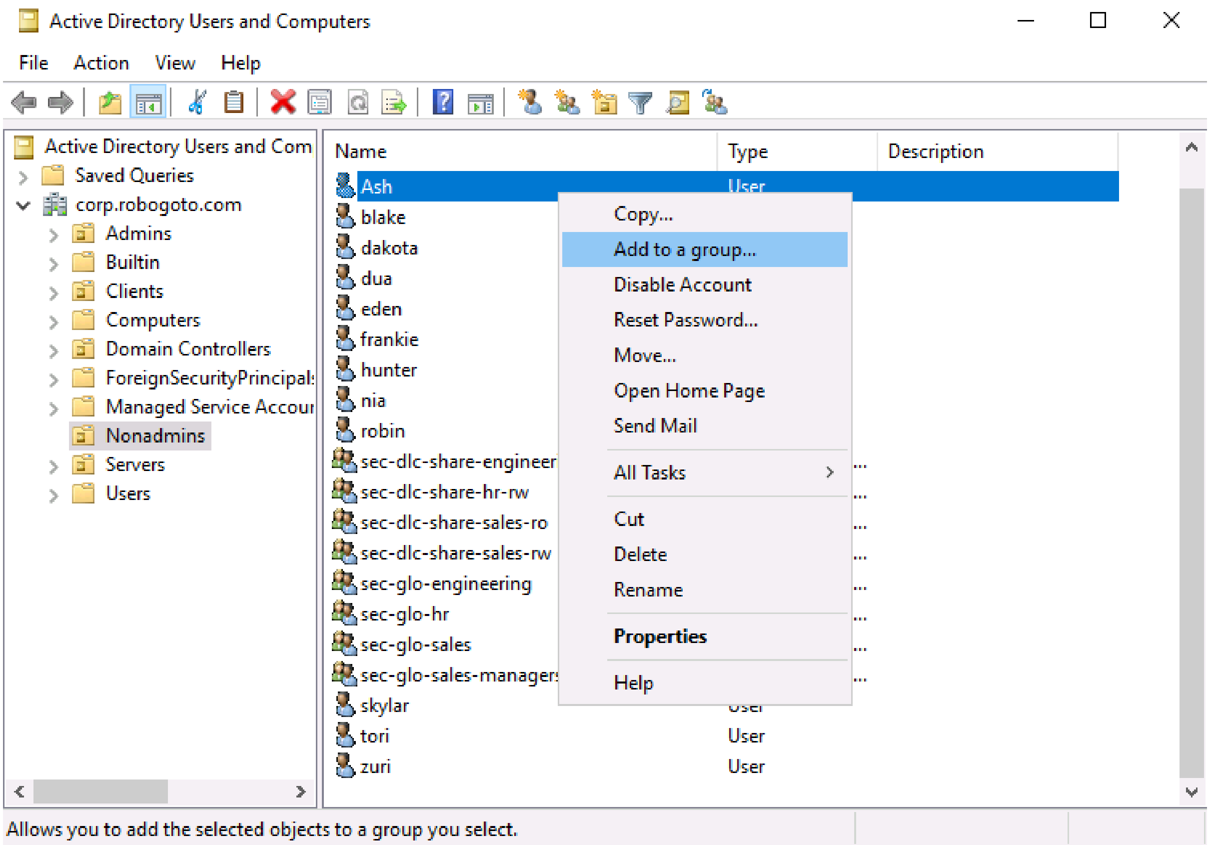
After accessing **Active Directory Users and Computers**, I right-clicked on an empty area within the appropriate organizational unit and selected **New** → **User**. I then created the **Ash** user account as requested.



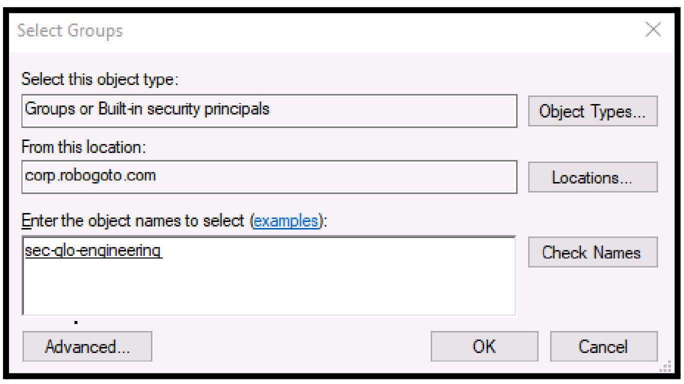
A temporary password was assigned during the creation of the user account. For security purposes, the **"User must change password at next logon"** option was enabled, requiring the user to create a new personal password during their first login.

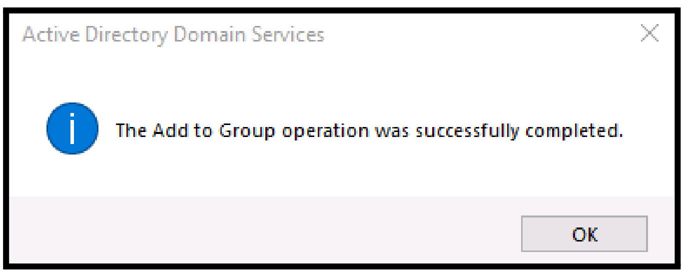


After creating the **"Ash"** user account, the next step was to assign the new employee to the appropriate Active Directory group. In this case, the user was added to the **Engineering** group to ensure they received the correct permissions and access required for their role.



After selecting **"Add to a Group"**, the next step was to assign the **"Ash"** user account to the appropriate Active Directory security group. The required group was **"sec-glo-engineering"**. After entering the group name, the **"Check Names"** option was selected to verify that the group name entered matched an existing object within Active Directory. This validation helps prevent errors by confirming that the specified group exists and can be correctly identified by the system. Once the group was successfully verified, **"OK"** was selected to apply the changes and complete the group assignment

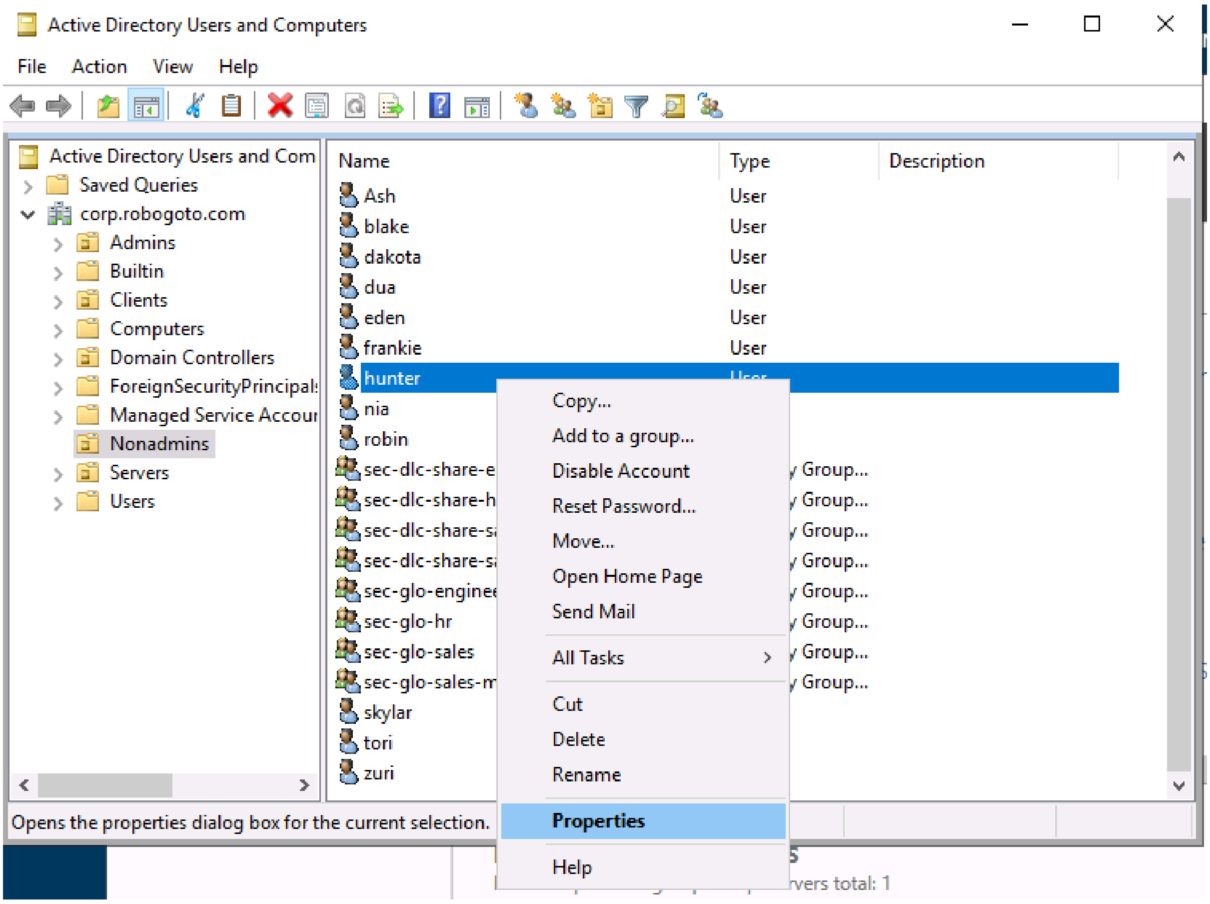




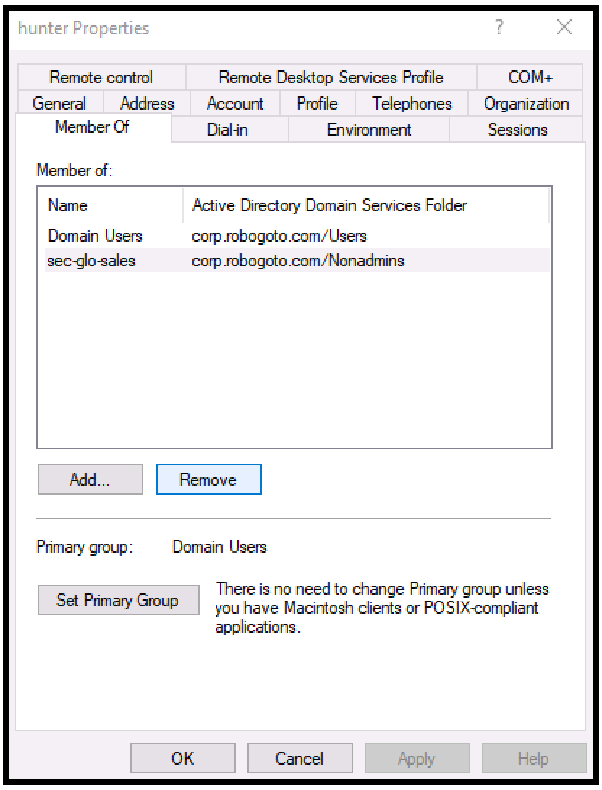
2. Modifying Existing User Information: “Hunter” Account Configuration

All required tasks for the **"Ash"** user account were successfully completed. The next step was to proceed with the assigned tasks for the **"Hunter"** user account, following the same Active Directory management procedures.

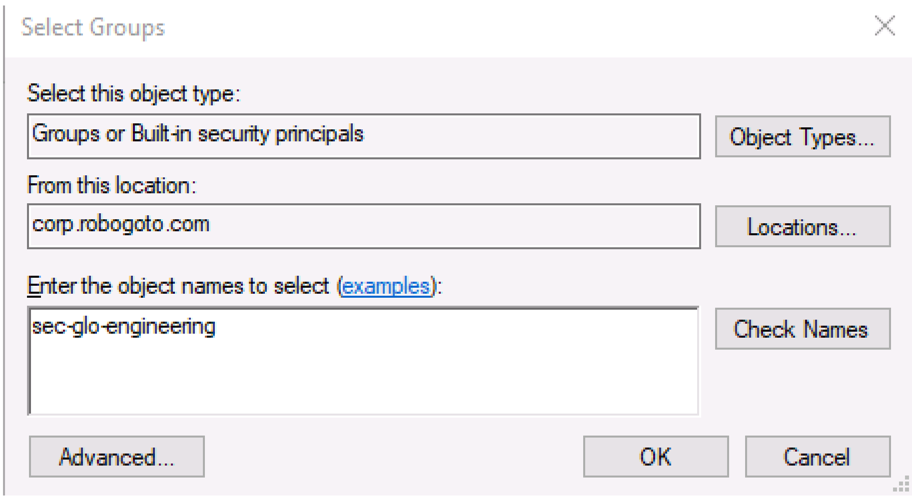
To begin configuring the **"Hunter"** user account, I accessed the user's properties by right-clicking on the account in **Active Directory Users and Computers** and selecting **"Properties"**. This opened the user management interface, allowing the required account information and settings to be modified.



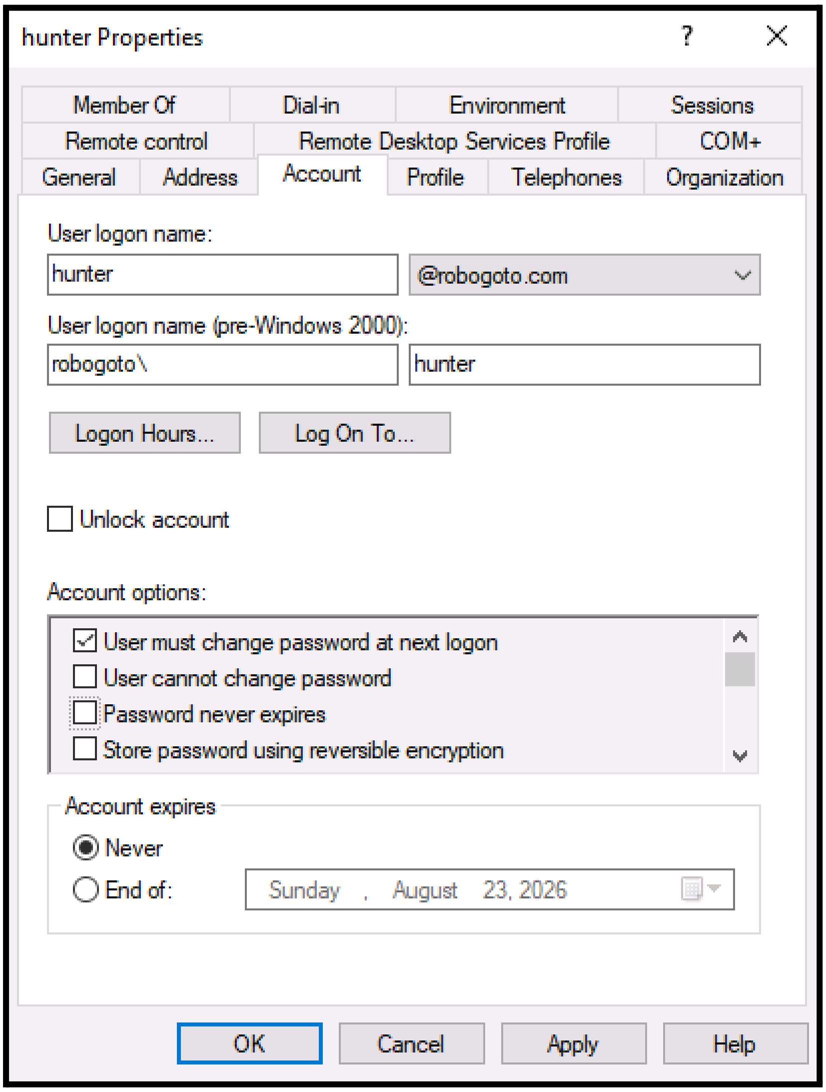
Within the **Hunter** user account properties, I navigated to the **"Member Of"** tab to review the groups assigned to the user. The **Sales** group was selected and removed to revoke Hunter’s previous department membership and ensure the account no longer had the associated permissions and access.



The final step in updating the **Hunter** user account was to assign the user to the correct department group. The **"sec-glo-engineering"** security group was added to Hunter’s account to provide the appropriate access and permissions associated with the Engineering department.



As the final step in configuring the **Hunter** user account, the required password security settings were updated. The **"User must change password at next logon"** option was enabled to ensure that Hunter creates a new personal password upon the next login. Additionally, the **"Password never expires"** option was verified to be disabled, ensuring that the account follows the organization's standard domain password expiration policies and requires periodic password updates.



Outcome

Both personnel requests were completed successfully according to the required company procedures and security policies.

The “**Ash”** user account was successfully created and configured within Active Directory. The account was assigned to the correct **Engineering** security group, placed in the appropriate **NonAdmins Organizational Unit (OU)**, and configured with security settings requiring the user to change their password during the first login. This ensured that the account followed standard security practices and did not have unnecessary administrative privileges.

The “**Hunter”** user account was successfully updated to reflect the requested department transfer. The previous department membership was removed, and the user was added to the correct **Engineering** security group to provide the appropriate access permissions for the new role. The account settings were also reviewed to ensure password security requirements were applied, including forcing a password change at the next login and maintaining standard domain password expiration policies.

After completing both requests, the user accounts were reviewed and verified to confirm that they were correctly configured, assigned to the proper security groups, located in the correct **NonAdmins OU**, and did not have administrative access. These steps ensured that both accounts followed the organization's security standards and the principle of Least Privilege.

Security Measures

The following security best practices were applied:

- Password reset required at next logon.
- Principle of Least Privilege followed.
- Administrative rights verified and removed if present.
- Correct Organizational Unit (OU) assignment confirmed.
- Appropriate security group membership verified.

Skills Demonstrated

- Active Directory User Management
- User Account Creation
- Department Transfers
- Security Group Administration
- Organizational Unit (OU) Management
- Password Policy Enforcement
- Principle of Least Privilege
- IT Documentation

Lessons Learned

This lab provided practical experience with essential Active Directory user management tasks and reinforced the importance of accurate account configuration in an enterprise environment. Through this exercise, I gained a better understanding of how user accounts are created, modified, and managed according to organizational requirements.

The lab also highlighted the importance of assigning users to the correct security groups, applying proper password policies, and ensuring that users have only the permissions required for their specific roles. These practices help maintain a secure environment by reducing the risk of unauthorized access and following the principle of least privilege.

The skills practiced in this lab represent common responsibilities performed by Tier 1 Help Desk and IT Support professionals, including onboarding new users, updating employee information, managing access permissions, and maintaining account security standards.

Portfolio Note

This report documents a hands-on lab completed as part of my CompTIA A+ studies. It demonstrates practical experience with Active Directory user administration in a simulated enterprise environment.